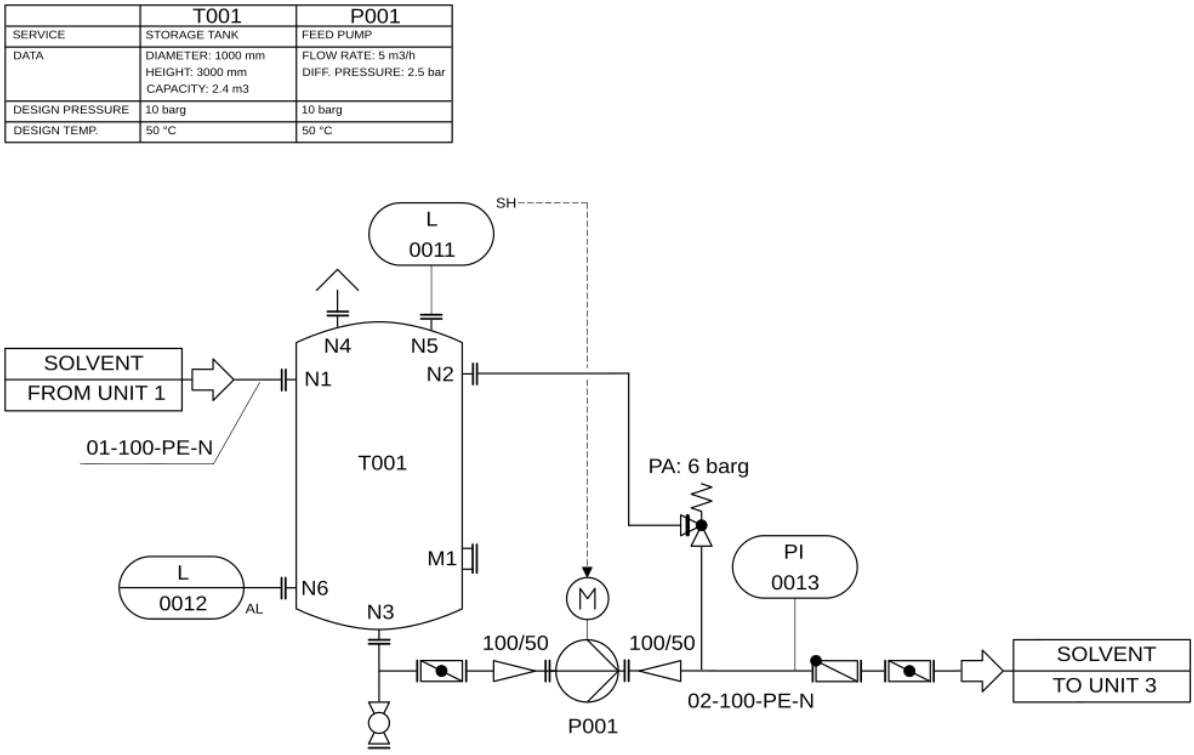


Figure 2.6 A sample piping and instrumentation (PID) diagram showing how complex physical systems can be logically represented in a diagram. Source Wikipedia. Licensed under CC BY-SA 3.0

Both PFD and P&ID documents are critical document based representations of a physical system that are important to consider when looking to capture that system (in this case, a complex industrial process) and represent it digitally. Their importance is due to:

- As documents that define, in great detail, the physical structure and relationships that make up the physical system they can be used to create an accurate digital model of the physical system.
- As documents related to the physical system, a digital twin can contextualize them, linking and relating them to other pieces of information within the organization. This assists in information retrieval and an associated reduction in the time taken to make high quality decisions.